

PRISM Scoring Rules

A plain-language reference for how PRISM indicator scores are built up, adjusted, and capped.

1. How a Score Is Built

1.1 What Raises the Score

Category	Contributing Signal
Threat evidence	Malware evidence on the indicator
	Presence of a named threat actor
	Linked incidents or events
Indicator metadata	Indicator type
	Recency — newer indicators add more than older ones
Ratings	ThreatConnect rating
	ThreatConnect confidence
	Threat scores from ThreatConnect, VirusTotal, and CAL
Network behavior	TOR activity
	TOR combined with strong malware evidence (extra impact)
Breadth	Number of sources reporting the indicator
	Number of partners reporting the indicator
Stacked context	Bonus when several strong signals appear together

1.2 What Lowers the Score

Adjustment	Effect
PB Scanning tags	Strong reduction to the total score
Observation volume	Penalty grows as observation volume grows
Botnet-related activity	Reduction, unless overridden by a boost tag or file-type rule
False-positive markers	Reduction
Scanner-related tags	Reduction
Mass-scanning behavior	Additional tiered penalties on top of scanner reduction

1.3 Overrides (Score Set Directly)

Condition	Result
Indicator is a file hash	Score is set to 900 (Critical) automatically

2. Boost Tags

Boost tags raise the score. They fall into three groups.

2.1 Country + Threat-Group Pairs

A boost applies only when **both** the country tag and a matching group tag are present.

Country	Paired Group Tags
Iran	MOIS, IRGC, IRGC QF, IRGC CEC, IRGC EWCD, *Sandstorm, *Kitten
Russia	SVR, FSB, GRU, *Blizzard, *Bear
China	MSS, PLA, PLA SSF, PLA CSF, PLAN, *Panda, *Typhoon, regional SSB groups
North Korea	RGB, *Chollima, *Sleet
Palestine	Hamas
Lebanon	Lebanese Hizballah

2.2 Standalone Boost Tags

Any one of these tags on its own triggers a boost.

Group	Tags
Country / affiliation	vietnam, belarus, palestine, pakistan, india, teamcp, cisco
Activity / capability	compromised, trivy, operational relay box, command and control (c2), data exfiltration, wiper, destructive wiper, data wiper, loader/dropper, backdoor/rat, ransomware, remote code execution (rce)
Targeted technology / campaign	Fortigate/fortinet, sap netweaver, apt & targeted attack, spacehop, orb, superjumper

2.3 CVE Tags

Any tag matching the pattern **CVE-####-#####** triggers a CVE boost.

3. Penalty Tags

Penalty tags lower the score. They fall into two groups.

3.1 PB Lowering Tags

Tags
soar indicator pb, scanning cdn pb, known scanning pb, web scanner, active scanning, scan, scanner, scanning

3.2 Botnet Activity Tags

Tags

scanning, ddos, spam, phishing, cryptojacking, credential stuffing, ransomware, data theft, cross site scripting attacks, sql injections

Note: *ransomware* and *scanning* appear in both boost and penalty contexts. The botnet penalty applies when the tag indicates botnet-driven behavior; it can be overridden by a stronger boost signal or by the file-hash override in §1.3.

4. Penalty Summary

Penalty Source	Severity
PB scanning tags	Significant reduction
Botnet tags	Reduction, unless overridden
Scanner tags	Reduction
High-volume scanning behavior	Additional tiered reduction